AI BADGE

Your First Skill

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Your AI team has personalities.

Now give them recipes.

A persona is who. A skill is how. One markdown file the agent runs the same way every time, on cue.

Persona is identity.

Skill is procedure. They sit on the same desk.

WHO · persona.md

- Aria the Scientist
- How she thinks. How she pushes back.
- Her voice. Her first five questions.
- Built once. Mostly stable over time.

HOW · skill.md

- weekly-funder-scan.md
- When to fire. What inputs to ask for.
- Steps in order. What good output looks like.
- One per repeatable task. Build a backlog.

One persona, many skills. Skills sit beside the persona file in your workspace.

Paste, run, answer five questions.

Works on ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot.

master-prompt.md

```
You are the Skill Maker.
Your job is to help me write one
SKILL.md file: a small reusable
procedure that one of my AI personas
can run on demand.

GROUND RULES
- Five questions max. One at a time.
- The trigger description is everything.
- Output one fenced markdown block.

START NOW WITH Q1.
```

The interview

Q1 Which persona owns this skill?

Q2 What task should the skill do?

Q3 When should it fire? (the trigger)

Q4 What does great output look like?

Q5 What inputs does it need?

One SKILL.md. Concrete, not generic.

weekly-funder-scan.md · owner: Aria

```
---
name: weekly-funder-scan
description: Use when scanning funders
  aligned to my cause. Triggers on:
  scan funders, any new grants?,
  Monday research.
owner: Aria the Scientist
---

# Weekly funder scan

## When to use
- Monday morning research blocks.
- Just before a grant deadline.

## Steps
1. Pull this week's open calls.
2. Filter to my cause area.
3. Rank by fit and deadline.
```

Every skill file has:

- **Trigger description**
  The line that tells the AI when to use this. The single most important field.
- **When to use**
  Three to five concrete situations. Plus a 'do not use when' if there's a false-trigger to avoid.
- **Inputs needed**
  What the skill needs from you. Required vs optional. What to ask for if missing.
- **Steps**
  The procedure. Numbered, short, no more than seven.
- **Output contract**
  Length, format, what's in it, what isn't.
- **One worked example**
  Real inputs in, real output out. Teaches the skill more than the steps do.

A skill that never fires is worthless.

Write triggers in your real words. The phrases you would actually say.

TOO GENERIC

`"a skill for funders"`

Will never fire on its own. The model has nothing concrete to match.

READY TO FIRE

`"scan funders" · "any new grants?" · "Monday research"`

Three real phrases. The model recognises one and runs the skill.

Save it. Load it. Say the words.

Save

01

Save the SKILL.md next to the persona file.
your-ai-workspace/skills/weekly-funder-scan.md

Load

02

New chat. Paste the persona file plus the skill file. Or attach both.

Trigger

03

Say one of your trigger phrases verbatim.
"Aria, any new grants?"

Iterate

04

Watch it run. Edit the steps if the output drifts. Skills are living documents.

If it does not fire on the first try, your trigger phrases need to be closer to your real words. Edit and re-test.

A persona who knows one task by heart.

One skill is a foothold. Build a backlog over time.

- **Today** — One persona, one skill, tested.
- **This week** — Three more skills. The tasks you do most.
- **Next month** — A small library of skills per persona.
- **Beyond** — Chains of skills become workflows.